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WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 29, 2025

Racing to reshape America

AMONG THE STEPS THE TRUMP ADMINISTRATION HAS ALREADY DONE OR IS SEEKING TO:

PARDONED OR COMMUTED SENTENCES OF JAN. 6. RIOTERS ■ FROZEN SCORES OF FEDERAL FUNDING PROGRAMS ■ SOUGHT TO END BIRTHRIGHT CITIZENSHIP ■ DISPATCHED US TROOPS TO MEXICO BORDER ■ ELIMINATED DIVERSITY PROGRAMS IN GOVERNMENT, PRIVATE SECTOR ■ ALLOW IMMIGRATION ENFORCEMENT IN CHURCHES AND SCHOOLS ■ FIRED JUSTICE DEPARTMENT PROSECUTORS INVOLVED IN INVESTIGATIONS OF HIS CONDUCT ■ WITHDREW FROM THE PARIS CLIMATE AGREEMENT ■ END TEMPORARY LEGAL STANDING FOR SOME MIGRANTS AND PAUSED REFUGEE AID ■ WITHDRAW FROM WORLD HEALTH ORGANIZATION ■ FROZEN FOREIGN AID FOR 90 DAYS ■ DECLARED US WILL RECOGNIZE ONLY TWO GENDERS ■ FIRED AS MANY AS 17 US AGENCY WATCHDOGS ■ SUSPENDED COMMUNICATIONS, PUBLICATIONS FROM FEDERAL HEALTH OFFICES ■ PAUSED APPROVAL OF OFFSHORE WIND PROJECTS ■ FROZEN NEW FUNDING FOR ELECTRIC VEHICLE PROGRAMS ■ RESCINDED 78 BIDEN EXECUTIVE ACTIONS ■ AUTHORIZED SHIPMENT OF 2,000 POUND BOMBS TO ISRAEL ■ RENAME GULF OF MEXICO GULF OF AMERICA AND DENALI TO MT. MCKINLEY ■ THREATENED LOCAL OFFICIALS WITH PROSECUTION FOR RESISTING DEPORTATIONS ■ BAN TRANSGENDER PEOPLE FROM US MILITARY

RESEARCH GRANTS

Scientists fear a chilling effect

By Anna Kuchment, Kay Lazar, and Neena Hagen
GLOBE STAFF

Sameer Sonkusale had already bought his nonrefundable plane ticket to Washington, D.C., to present his research for federal funding when the email pinged into his inbox last week.

The session, which was scheduled for Tuesday was canceled “due to new guidance.” The email said he would be notified about next steps, but so far he’s heard nothing. Sonkusale, a Tufts University professor of biological, chemical, and electrical engineering, was among six teams of scientists who were slated to compete for a National Institutes of Health design innovation grant to translate their research into a health care product. The group was to present a new approach for detecting sepsis in newborns.

Within hours of taking office last week, the Trump administration unleashed a torrent of directives that upended work at the country’s major health and science agency

NIH, Page A7

FUNDING FREEZE NOW ON HOLD

An unclear memo unleashes chaos

By Tal Kopan and Jim Puzzanghera
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — As dawn broke Tuesday, congressional offices in Massachusetts and around the country were flooded with questions: Preschool administrators couldn’t log in to their federal Head Start portals. Community health centers were similarly locked out. Local hospitals were unsure if federal funds were still accessible.

Everyone wanted to know the same thing: had the Trump administration actually frozen federal funds and would they be able to keep functioning? On Tuesday morning, the answer from Washington was: we’re trying to figure that out. Even as the White House tried to clarify the scope of the order throughout the day, the confusion had already impacted beneficiaries of federal funds and prompted legal challenges.

By Tuesday afternoon, a federal judge had put the order on a brief stay while challenges to the administration work their way through the courts. But the controversy

FREEZE, Page A6

MASSACHUSETTS

So many programs would be affected

By Danny McDonald, Samantha J. Gross, Jason Laughlin, and John Hilliard
GLOBE STAFF

The Trump administration’s attempt to temporarily freeze federal grants and loans was temporarily blocked by a federal judge Tuesday afternoon as lawmakers, local officials, and advocates worried it could throw trillions of dollars into limbo and cause widespread chaos in schools, health centers and hospitals, child care centers and universities, and on public works and transit operations.

In a memo late Monday, Matthew J. Vaeth, acting director for the federal Office of Management and Budget, set out the Trump’s administration’s reasoning for the freeze: “The use of Federal resources to advance Marxist equity, transgenderism, and green new deal social engineering policies is a waste of taxpayer dollars that does not improve the day-to-day lives of those we serve.”

But US District Judge Loren L. AliKhan blocked the administration’s action, minutes before it was set to go

MASSACHUSETTS, Page A7



JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

On a key part of would-be job, Kennedy has been quiet

Views on Medicare, Medicaid likely to face scrutiny this week

By Sam Brodey
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — Robert F. Kennedy Jr. has ventured a staggering number of opinions on public health, from casting doubt on vaccines and fluoride to claiming COVID was engineered to spare some races.

There’s one area, however, where the notoriously voluble Kennedy has been relatively quiet. It happens to concern the biggest responsibilities of the federal agency he could soon run.

The Department of Health and Human Services, which President Trump nominated Kennedy to lead, has sweeping jurisdiction over public health, but it administers two of the most critical programs in the social safety net: Medicare and Medicaid. Together, they provide health coverage to tens of millions of seniors, low-income Americans, and children, accounting for over 80 percent of the annual HHS budget. The department also spends tens of billions of dollars on supporting health coverage under the Affordable Care Act.

But Kennedy has said very little about the programs or expressed much interest in them at all,

KENNEDY, Page A10



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

On Tuesday, Mayor Michelle Wu made her first in-person appearance at City Hall since delivering her third child two weeks ago.

Wu cool to House panel’s call for her to testify on immigration

By Emma Platoff and Samantha J. Gross
GLOBE STAFF

A new Republican-led Washington has put Boston and its mayor in its crosshairs, spotlighting the city’s immigration policies and positioning Mayor Michelle Wu to become the face of a liberal resistance movement, should she choose.

Wu gave a measured response Tuesday after a Republican-led congressional committee singled out Boston as one of four cities that “stand out in their abject failure to comply” with federal immigration law, and asked Wu to appear before the panel in Washington

next month.

“D.C. is going to play politics. Let them do what they’re doing. We’re going to stay focused on serving our communities here,” Wu said at City Hall, in her first in-person appearance since she delivered her third child two weeks ago. “We have our domain, and we feel very strongly that we’re on solid legal ground.”

The mayor touted Boston as “the safest major city in the country” and promised, “we’ll respond in due time” to the letter. She did not commit to appearing before the committee, and has not received a subpoena to do so.

WU, Page A10

On the up and down

Wednesday: Windy, cold late. High 42-47. Low 14-19.

Thursday: Sunny, icy. High 24-29. Low 23-28.

High tide: 10:48 a.m., 11:25 p.m. Sunrise: 7:01 Sunset: 4:54

Weather and Comics, G6-7. Obituaries, C9.

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La Padrona, at the Raffles hotel, combines luxury, hospitality, and Italian cuisine (above, osso buco), says food writer Devra First. **G1.**

Massachusetts state agencies entered into at least 159 settlements with employees over a 13-year span that included some type of nondisclosure or confidentiality clause. **B1.**

A man with close ties to the woman accused of fatally shooting a Border Patrol agent in Vermont allegedly killed an 82-year-old man in California to prevent him from testifying against his friends in court. **B1.**

China’s new AI system DeepSeek isn’t really anything to worry about, unless you’re a tech giant, writes Hiawatha Bray. **B5.**